

exposed or shielded you were from the financial goings on in your childhood.

Of course, this is complicated by the fact that internal and external factors in financial wellbeing are also interdependent. They feed off one another, in ways both positive and negative. Encountering difficult financial situations or hardship can affect your confidence, self-worth and decision-making processes, which can then compound to create a toxic relationship with money that needs to be overcome. Meanwhile, developing inner resilience can have a positive effect on your external circumstances through the medium of your actions and being open to opportunities. This, in turn, can compound your fortunes in the opposite direction and help you to feel more confident and in control, which improves your relationship with money and often, also, your material financial situation.

Most of us will have a whole suite of systemic and personal factors, over which we have limited or no control, that affect our financial situation and relationship with money. It's important that we try to understand these, both to apply context to our actions in the past, and to make sure that our expectations of ourselves don't outweigh our resources.